EW 4

Reflexive verbs

21. Verbs which are used reflexively (i.e. with reflexive pronouns) are more frequent in French than in English. Such verbs need to be learnt with their reflexive pronoun BUT when you use them **YOU MUST USE THE CORRECT REFLEXIVE PRONOUN FOR THE SUBJECT**.

Some examples			
to open (INTRANS.)	:	*s'ouvrir*	*La porte s'est ouverte*
to meet (INTRANS.)	:	*se rencontrer*	*Nous nous sommes rencontrés hier*
to know one another	:	*se connaître*	*Vous ne vous connaissez pas?*
to write to one another	:	*s'écrire*	*Ils s'écrivent régulièrement*

22. In compound tenses reflexive verbs are ALWAYS conjugated with ETRE

egs.			
	she stopped	:	*elle s'est arrêtée*
	I had remembered	:	*je m'étais souvenu(e)*
	we shall have washed	:	*nous nous serons lavé(e)s*
	I would have apologised:		*je me serais excusé(e)*

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23. Past participle agreement with reflexive verbs in compound tenses

The reflexive pronoun must be thought of as an ordinary pronoun : if it is a preceding direct object the past participle will have the appropriate agreement; if it is an indirect object there will be no agreement. In the majority of cases it will be a direct object and thus there will be an agreement.

To find out if the pronoun is direct or indirect ask yourself if the basic verb, before it was made reflexive, takes a direct or indirect object of the person:

se laver:	*laver quelqu'un* therefore the **se is a direct object**	*elle s'est lavée*
se demander:	*demander à quelqu'un* thus the **se is an indirect object**	*elle s'est demandé_*

It follows that there will be no agreement with, for example, any of the following verbs:

se rappeler (to remember)	*: elle s'est rappelé son adresse*	*(rappeler à qn)*
se dire	*: elle s'est dit que ….*	*(dire à qn)*
se rendre compte (to realise)	*: ils se sont rendu compte que ….*	*(rendre compte à qn)*
se faire		

Quite simply, the rule for the agreement of the past participle is the same as the one for verbs taking *avoir* in past tenses: if there is a PDO the past participle agrees with the PDO; if there is a preceding INDIRECT object there is no agreement.

Note also the following cases where there will be no agreement of the past participle:

i) with reflexive pronouns that denote action done to a part of the body

She brushed her hair	*Elle s'est brossé les cheveux*
We washed our hands	*Nous nous sommes lavé les mains*
They wiped their mouths	*Ils se sont essuyé la bouche*

ii) where the reflexive pronoun means TO / FOR ONE ANOTHER or FOR ONESELF

We wrote to one another	*Nous nous sommes écrit*	*(écrire à qn)*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

She bought herself a new hat *Elle s'est acheté un nouveau chapeau* *(acheter à qn)*

24.To Remember : DISTINGUISH between the 2 possible structures

i) se rappeler qch *ils se sont rappelé le nom de la rue*

ii) se souvenir de qch *ils se sont souvenus du nom de la rue*

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25. A reflexive verb is sometimes used to render the English passive Learn these examples:

That is said / That is done : *Cela se dit / Cela se fait*

Cigarettes are sold at the café: *Les cigarettes se vendent au café*

Note particularly the use of **SE FAIRE + INFINITIVE** which is sometimes the equivalent of the English `**to be ------ ed'** (literally `**to get oneself ------ed**'

eg She was run over *Elle s'est fait écraser* [NEVER an agreement on *fait* + INF]

They were arrested *Ils se sont fait arrêter* [NEVER an agreement on *fait* + INF]

We were photographed *Nous nous sommes fait photographier* [NEVER an agreement on *fait* + INF]

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26. Some common reflexive verbs that always take DE before a noun

to approach something/s.o.	*s'approcher DE*	to do without sthg	:	*se passer DE*
to use something:	*se servir DE*	to mistrust s.o./sthg	:	*se méfier DE*
to apologise for sthg:	*s'excuser DE*	to make fun of	:	*se moquer DE*

The past participles of all these verbs agree with the reflexive pronoun in compound tenses.

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27. Use of « celui, celle, ceux, celles»

These words are pronouns (replacing nouns) and must take the number and gender of the noun they replace.

celui (masc. sing); **celle** (fem sing); **ceux** (masc plur); **celles** (fem plur)

They are used in **three ways only** and are never used without one of -**ci/là; de; qui/que/dont:**

i) with *-ci* and *là* to mean "this one" or "that one" or "these"

Quelles voitures? - Celles-ci ou celles-là? **Which cars? - These or those?**

ii) with *de* to convey the English ---'s or ---s'

Je n'ai pas vu ta maison mais j'ai vu celle de Paul **[...] but I have seen Paul's**

iii) with *qui* or *que* to mean "the one[s] which"

Celle que *j'ai vue était grande* **The one I saw was big**

or *dont* to mean "the one[s] of which/the one about which"

Ceux dont *tu parles sont les miens* **Those you are talking about are mine**

or *dont* when the verb following the pronoun takes *de* before a noun

Celles dont *j'ai besoin sont plus petites* **Those I need are smaller**

Note also **`the [ADJECTIVE] one'/ `the [ADJECTIVE] ones'**

Just le/la/les + adjective (nb MAKE ADJECTIVE AGREE WITH THE NOUN REFERRED TO)

the tall **one** :	*le grand/la grande*	the red **one** : *le rouge/la rouge*
the round **ones** :	*les ronds/les rondes*	the other **ones** : *les autres*

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